Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣4

Board: 3
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥J

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♠10

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K J 5
♥ K 6
♦ A Q 6 2
♣ 10 7 2

♠ 3
♥ A 9 8 4 3
♦ J 10 8 3
♣ Q J 4



♠ 10 9 8 6
♥ 2
♦ 9 5 4
♣ A K 9 6 5

♠ Q 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7 5
♦ K 7
♣ 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣K

This is a companion hand to Deal 16.

NORTH shows four ♠s following SOUTH's Stayman bid.

So SOUTH ignores her five ♥s, having already found an 8-card Major suit fit. With the fit her hand now revalues to 11 points so she bids 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 3 ♥ 9 8 3 2 ♦ 9 5 4 3 ♣ K Q 5	
♠ Q 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 7 5 ♦ K 7 ♣ 8 3	N W E S	♠ A K 5 ♥ K 6 ♦ A Q 6 2 ♣ J 10 7 2
	♠ J 9 8 6 ♥ A 4 ♦ J 10 8 ♣ A 9 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♣4

This is companion #3 to Deal 16 and 17.

WEST again starts with Stayman, and after EAST denies a 4-card Major, WEST shows her five ♥s.

But in this Deal EAST has only a doubleton ♥, so he chooses to play 3NT.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J ♥ A K 6 ♦ J 9 5 3 ♣ K J 9 6	
♠ A 7 3 ♥ J 10 8 ♦ A 10 8 4 2 ♣ 10 5		♠ 9 2 ♥ 9 4 2 ♦ K Q 6 ♣ 8 7 4 3 2
	♠ Q 10 8 6 5 4 ♥ Q 7 5 3 ♦ 7 ♣ A Q	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥J

Even with a 6-card ♠ suit SOUTH uses Stayman because he also has a 4-card ♥ suit. Given a choice, playing a 4-4 Major fit is usually preferable to a 6-2 or even a 6-3 fit.

But here NORTH doesn't have four ♥s so SOUTH just bids the game where he knows the partnership holds eight trumps.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 9 8 6 4 ♥ 2 ♦ J 10 7 2 ♣ 7 6 3	
♠ A 7 ♥ K J 6 5 ♦ A 8 4 ♣ K Q 10 8		♠ K Q 3 ♥ Q 10 9 8 4 3 ♦ K 5 ♣ A 5
	♠ J 5 2 ♥ A 7 ♦ Q 9 6 3 ♣ J 9 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♦	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♠10

WEST breaks the expected Transfer sequence by jumping to 3♥ instead of bidding just 2♥. This is called the "Super Accept" and it shows a hand with four of the trump suit with maximum point count.

EAST's ♣ bid and WEST's ♦ bid are Control bids, showing first round control of the suit that was bid.